



Conduct Expectations

You never know what is happening in another person's world. Be compassionate, above all else.

The purpose of this document is to inform all Green Dog Dental & Wellness ("Green Dog") employees of Green Dog's conduct expectations. This is not meant to be a complete list, but simply a highlight of some key points. All employees are expected to ensure an atmosphere of cooperation and mutual respect; this includes treating everyone with kindness and courtesy at all times. Professional reputations are important to all of us – therefore, refrain from speaking ill, disrespectfully, or discourteously of other employees. All employees are expected to bring any questions or concerns to management's attention in a professional and constructive manner. Veterinarians are considered leaders in the clinic and are expected to set a professional and positive leadership example through their job performance and conduct.

Our team is expected to behave in alignment with these very reasonable expectations. By following the basic guidelines below, we can all ensure a respectful workplace and work towards building a culture where all employees can find joy and meaning in their contributions.

A RESPECTFUL WORKPLACE

In accordance with section 1.4 of the Employee Handbook

Green Dog is committed to providing a respectful and professional work environment. In order to achieve this goal, we ask that our employees refrain from using foul language. Further, we ask you to speak to each other, other veterinary professionals, and to vendors and clients in a courteous and respectful manner. Verbal abuse will not be tolerated. Employees are also asked to refrain from yelling and shouting at colleagues or clients in accordance with these guidelines. Finally, professional reputations are important assets, and Green Dog does not permit maliciously false or slanderous remarks to be made by one employee about another. Nothing in this policy is intended to prohibit or discourage speech protected by the National Labor Relations Act.

We encourage the following behaviors and communication:

- Respectful, supportive, and encouraging language
- Assuming positive intent (giving people the benefit of the doubt)
- Question with a sense of curiosity
- Provide direct, constructive, and timely feedback
- Express appreciation for work well-done
- Trust each other's decision-making abilities
- Approach conflict with a desire for resolution
- Approach problems with a solutions mindset

- Commit to a positive attitude; optimism is contagious
- Embrace teamwork and look for opportunities to help others

The following behaviors are not conducive to a respectful workplace and will not be tolerated:

- Making negative, inaccurate, and unkind remarks to or about coworkers and clients
- Gossiping and spreading rumors
- Excluding, ostracizing, or ignoring others
- Foul language, inappropriate or offensive gestures
- Sexual, profane, or offensive discussions, including jokes, anecdotes, or sharing personal experiences
- Overly casual behavior, such as discussing topics that a reasonable person would consider inappropriate for the workplace
- Yelling or shouting, talking down to, ridiculing, degrading, or speaking in a condescending manner to others
- Ignoring requests for help from a co-worker
- Ignoring or refusing to follow through with a reasonable request from management
- Retaliation toward any employee for bringing a concern to management's attention

Management Responsibilities:

- Set a positive example; lead by doing
- Promote awareness of policy and complaint procedures
- Be vigilant for signs of inappropriate behavior and take action to resolve that behavior
- Exercise a diplomatic approach with all parties involved in a situation
- Embrace our open-door policy
- Be approachable
- Listen intently to truly understand

Employee Responsibilities:

- Report unacceptable behaviors that are not resolved by a direct approach
- Cooperate with preventative measures introduced by management
- Recognize that unacceptable behaviors will be dealt with through appropriate disciplinary measures
- Recognize that unfounded complaints may also be dealt with through disciplinary measures

Process for Investigation of Complaints:

- Whenever possible, all incidents should initially be dealt with directly by those involved, unless there are extenuating circumstances. Employees will be reminded of this responsibility before a formal complaint is accepted. If an employee is not comfortable addressing a co-worker, then he/she should report his/her concern directly to management.
- A formal complaint will contain the following details:

- o Date, time, and location
 - o Details of incident(s)
 - o Other witness(es)
- Any member of the management team (managers, medical director, supervisors) may receive complaints.
- The individuals involved will be notified that an allegation has been made with a presumption of innocence.
- The complaint will be diligently investigated.
- If there is a finding of inappropriate behavior, the manager will provide an action plan that could include training, coaching, and/or disciplinary action.

Training Programs:

- Training guidelines will be presented to all new hires.
- These guidelines may be reviewed or referenced during clinic meetings.

All employees are expected to adhere to Green Dog's policies at all times.